

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

A Very Merry *Murder*

A Cozy Christmas Murder Mystery Party Game

6-16 PLAYERS

90 MIN-2.5 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF



Start Here



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

LETTER + A4 · 12 CHARACTER BOOKLETS



What is in this kit

A **Very Merry Murder** is a cozy Christmas murder mystery party for 6 to 16 players: up to 12 get their own role, and bigger groups pair up on roles. No gore and no adult content, so it suits family Christmas, friends and office parties alike.

#	FILE	FOR	PRINT
00	START-HERE	Host	Optional
01	Host-Guide	Host	1 (or on screen)
02	Invitations + E-Invites + Invitation Maker	Each guest	1 per guest, or send
03	Cast-List	Everyone	1–2
10–21	Booklets (12 files)	One player each	Only roles in use
22	All-Booklets-Combined	Optional	All 12 at once
30	Evidence-Cards	Host reveals	1 set
31 · 32	Name-Tags · Accusation-Ballots	Everyone	1 set · 1 per player
33	Detective-Notes + Deputy briefs	Everyone	1 per player
34 · 35	Awards, Table Signs · Party Decor	Host	Optional
99	SOLUTION-Host-Only	Host only	Last

PRINT ORDER

01 Host Guide → 02 Invitations → 03 Cast List → booklets → 30–35 → **99 last**. Short on time? See the one-hour prep plan on page 4 of the Host Guide.

Do not open file 99

99-SOLUTION-Host-Only.pdf holds the answer. Print it last, without reading it, and seal it in an envelope until the reveal.

Players & cast



PLAYERS	CAST
6	Core only: Robin Holly, Jordan Tinsel, Sam Garland, Casey Sleigh, Alex Snow, Morgan Ivy
7	+ Taylor Star (the hired Santa)
8	+ Charlie Bell (marketing manager)
9	+ Frankie Fir (the gardener)
10	+ Quinn Mistletoe (the journalist)
11	+ Jamie Pudding (the village baker)
12	+ Riley Carol (the hired pianist)
13–16	All 12 roles. Couples or friends share a role as a pair (two Caseys from Sleigh Bells Catering, Santa and an elf as Taylor), or extra guests play Deputy Detectives with their own brief (file 33).

EVERY ROLE IS FOR ANYONE

All 12 characters work for any guest: the names and costumes are gender-neutral. The host plays Inspector Noel and joins in all evening.

How the night runs

1. Opening scene: the host reads Script 1.
2. Three rounds of mingling, questions and new evidence. Each round, every booklet gives its player things to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task.
3. Everyone fills in an accusation ballot.
4. The host reads the reveal and hands out awards.



How many people can play?

6 to 16. Up to 12 players each get their own role; with 13 to 16, guests share roles or play Deputy Detectives.

How long does it take?

About 2 to 2.5 hours with a dinner break, or about 90 minutes with the Express version in the Host Guide (it can be played seated at one table).

Can teens play? Is it work-friendly?

Yes. It is a cozy mystery with no gore and no adult content.

Can the host play too?

Yes. You play Inspector Noel, read the scripts and question the suspects. Read the solution in advance or keep it sealed and solve along with everyone.

How much prep is it?

For 6 players the essentials are 28 printed pages (booklets, 2 evidence pages, 2 ballot pages) and 12 cards to cut. Everything else is optional.

Can I print in black and white? Letter or A4?

Yes, all text and lines are dark on light paper. Both paper sizes are included as separate folders; print at 100%.

Is the mystery fair?

Yes. The answer can be worked out from the evidence cards alone, and every innocent suspect is cleared by evidence. The full clue chain is in file 99.

What if someone cancels?

The Host Guide has a removable characters table and a plan for last-minute changes.

Clue & Candle Games. An original story; any resemblance to real people or companies is coincidental. Written with AI assistance. Every clue was checked against the solution, and every round was walked through for each character.